



principles of social psychology

1st international edition, Stangor, Jhangiani, & Tarry



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Introducing Social Psychology

History &
Principles

Affect,
Behavior, &
Cognition

Conducting
Research

2 Questions

Is it ok to go
outside in a bikini?

Is it ok to go
outside in your
underwear?



scientific study

of how we

feel about,

think about, and

behave toward the

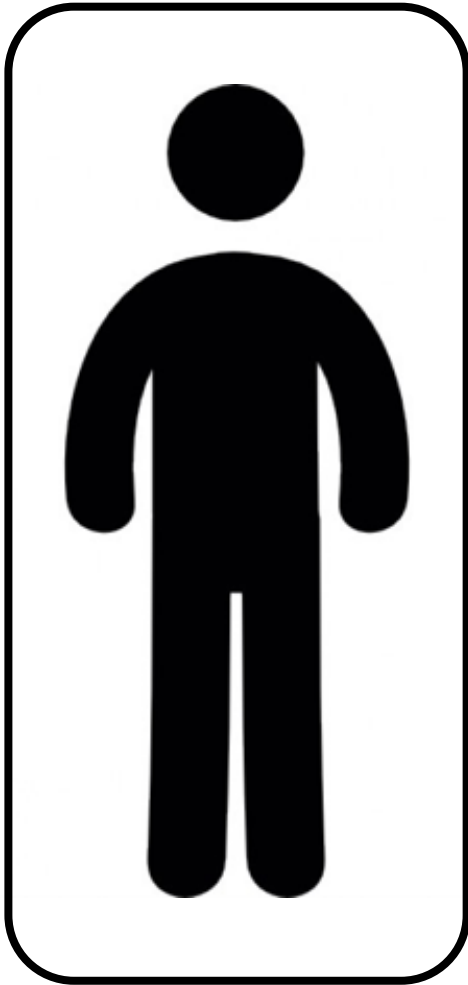
people around us

Social influence

is the process through which other people change our thoughts, feelings, and behaviors, and through which we change theirs.

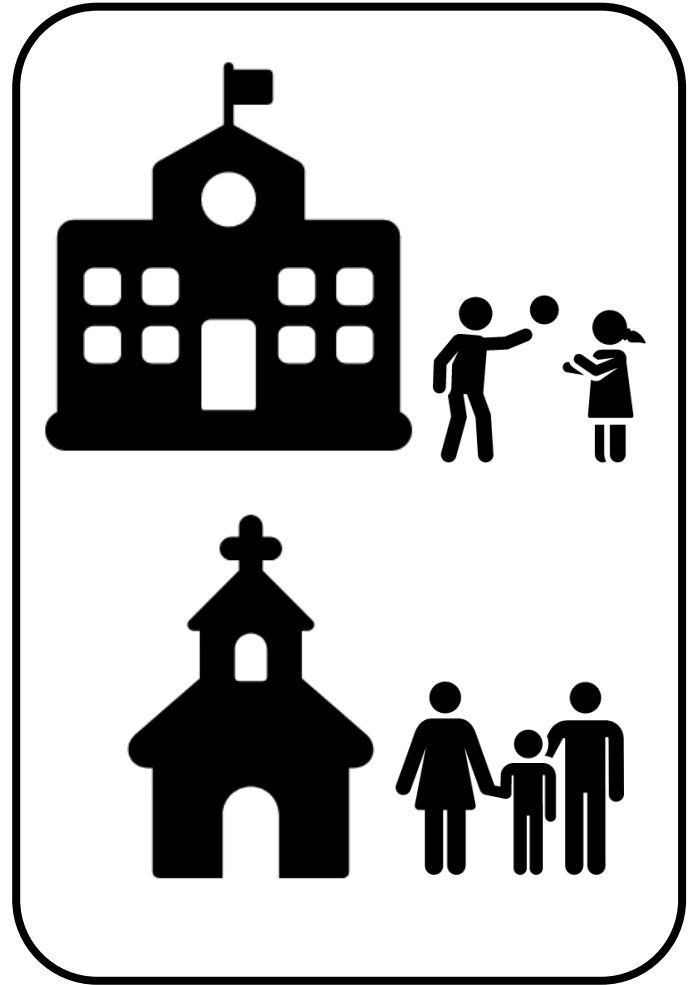


$$\mathbf{behavior} = f(\text{person, social situation})$$



person

Examples?

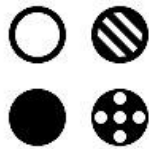


social situation

evolutionary adaptation



Social behaviors are **heritable**.



There is **variation** in social behaviors.

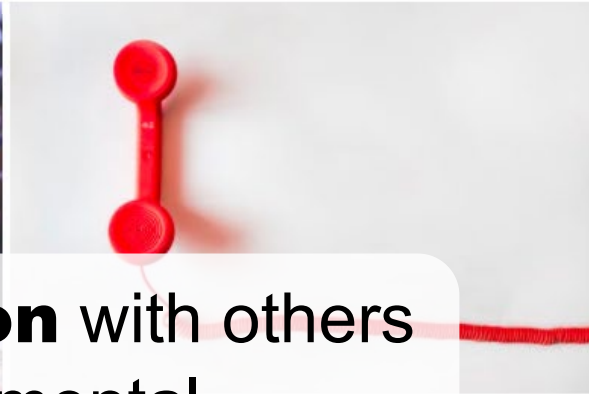


Some social behaviors convey better **fitness**.

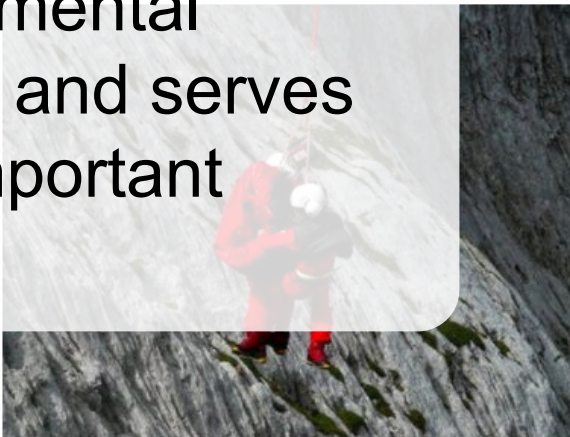
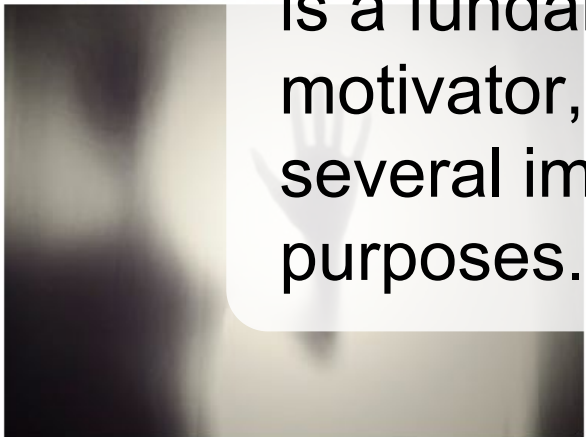
self-concern,
kin selection,



&
ingroups



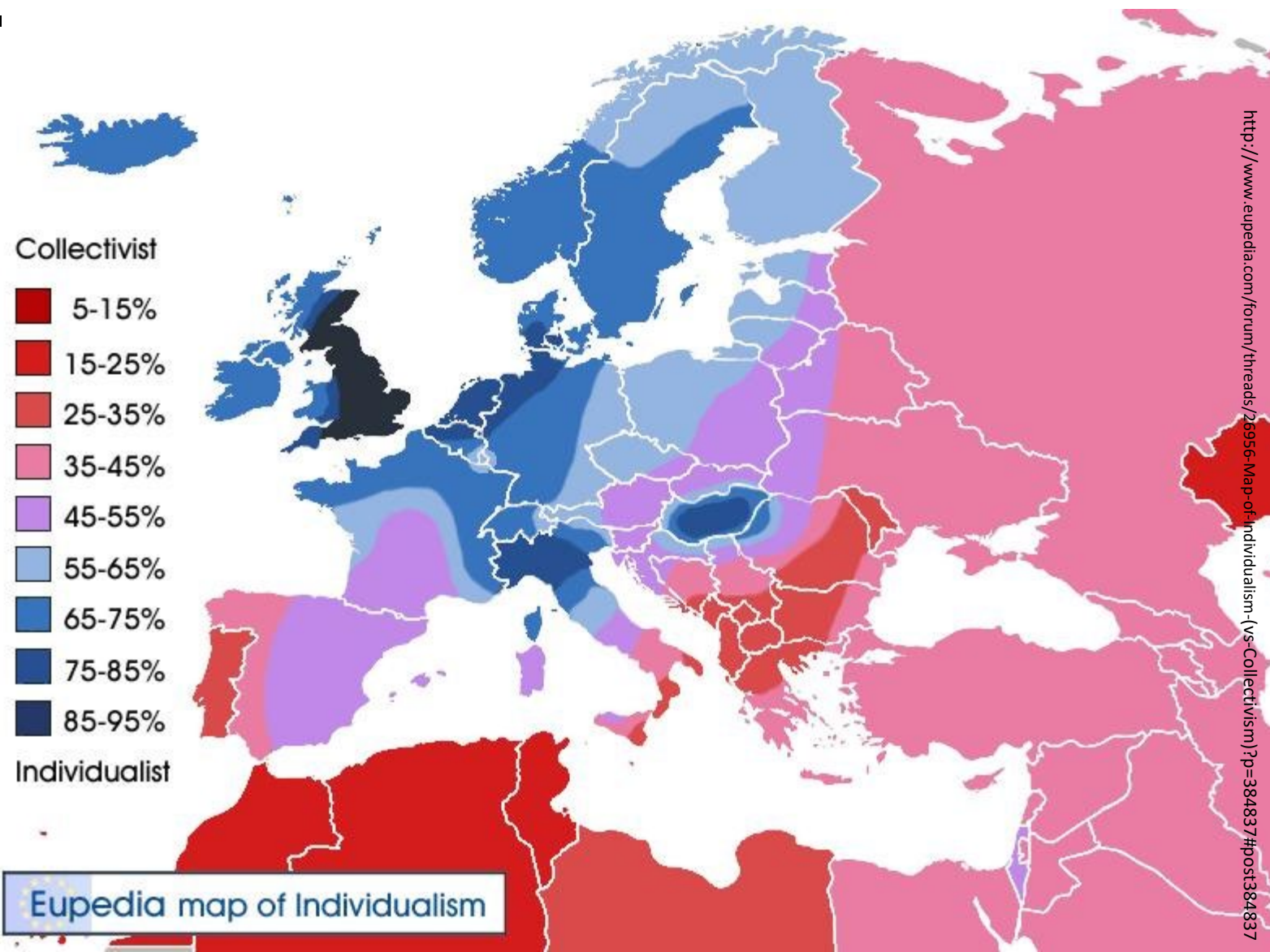
Affiliation with others is a fundamental motivator, and serves several important purposes.



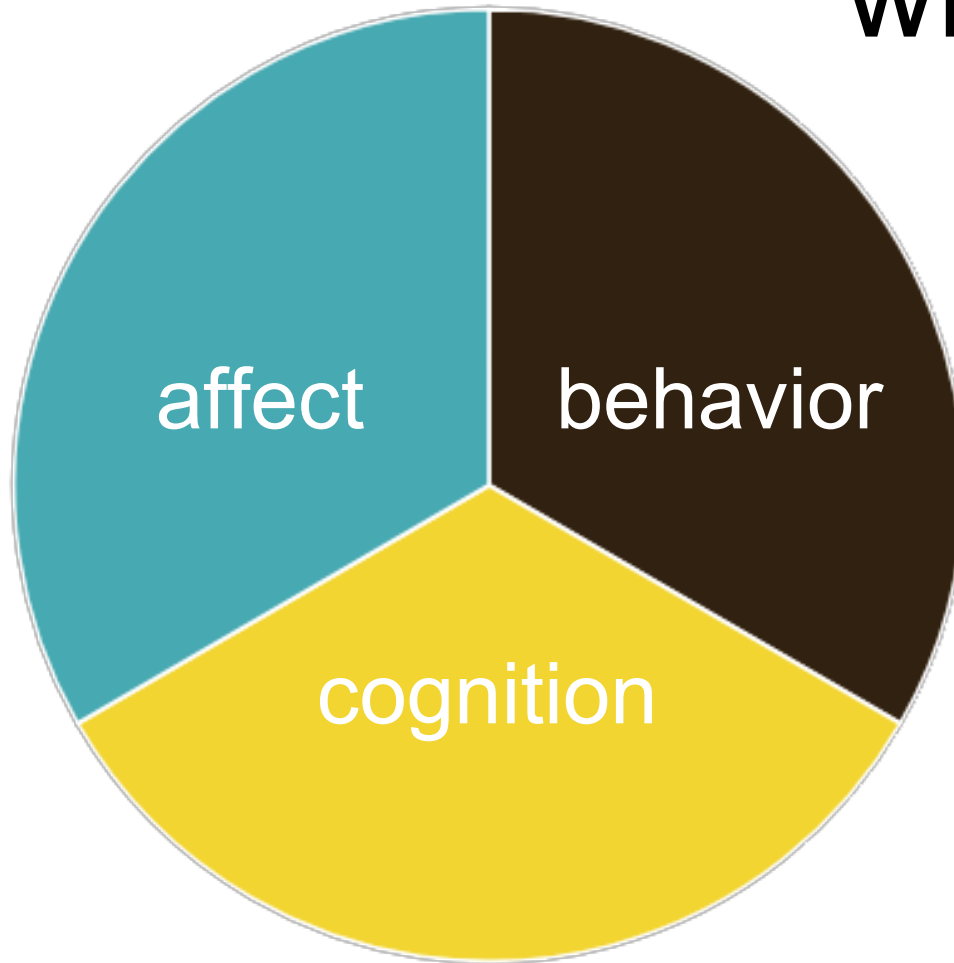


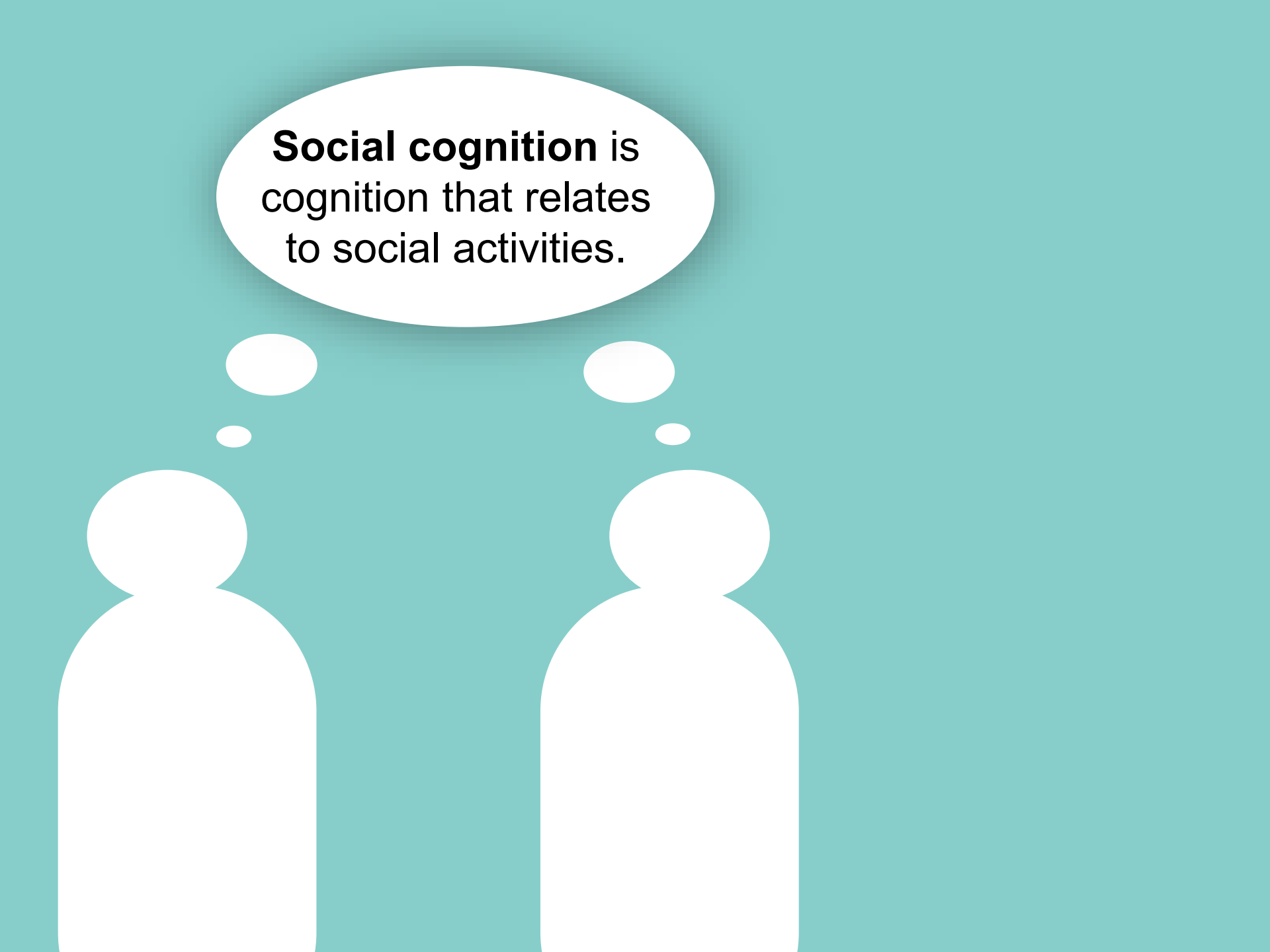
Lining up for transit is
an example of a
Social norm.

Different **cultures**
have different
norms.



Interacting with others



The diagram features a teal background. At the bottom, there are two white, stylized human figures. Above each figure is a small white thought bubble. A larger white oval, which serves as a container for text, is positioned above the space between the two figures. This oval has a subtle drop shadow.

Social cognition is
cognition that relates
to social activities.

What do
you **know**
about
doctors?

How do you
feel about
doctors?



A **schema** is a knowledge representation that includes information about a person or group.

An **attitude** is a knowledge representation that includes primarily our liking or disliking of a person, thing, or group.



affect



Mood is in
background, while
emotion is brief, but
often intense.

social **exchange** **e**



reciprocal altruism



Adaptations for **providing benefits to non-relatives** can evolve as long as the delivery of benefits is **reciprocated** at some point in the future.

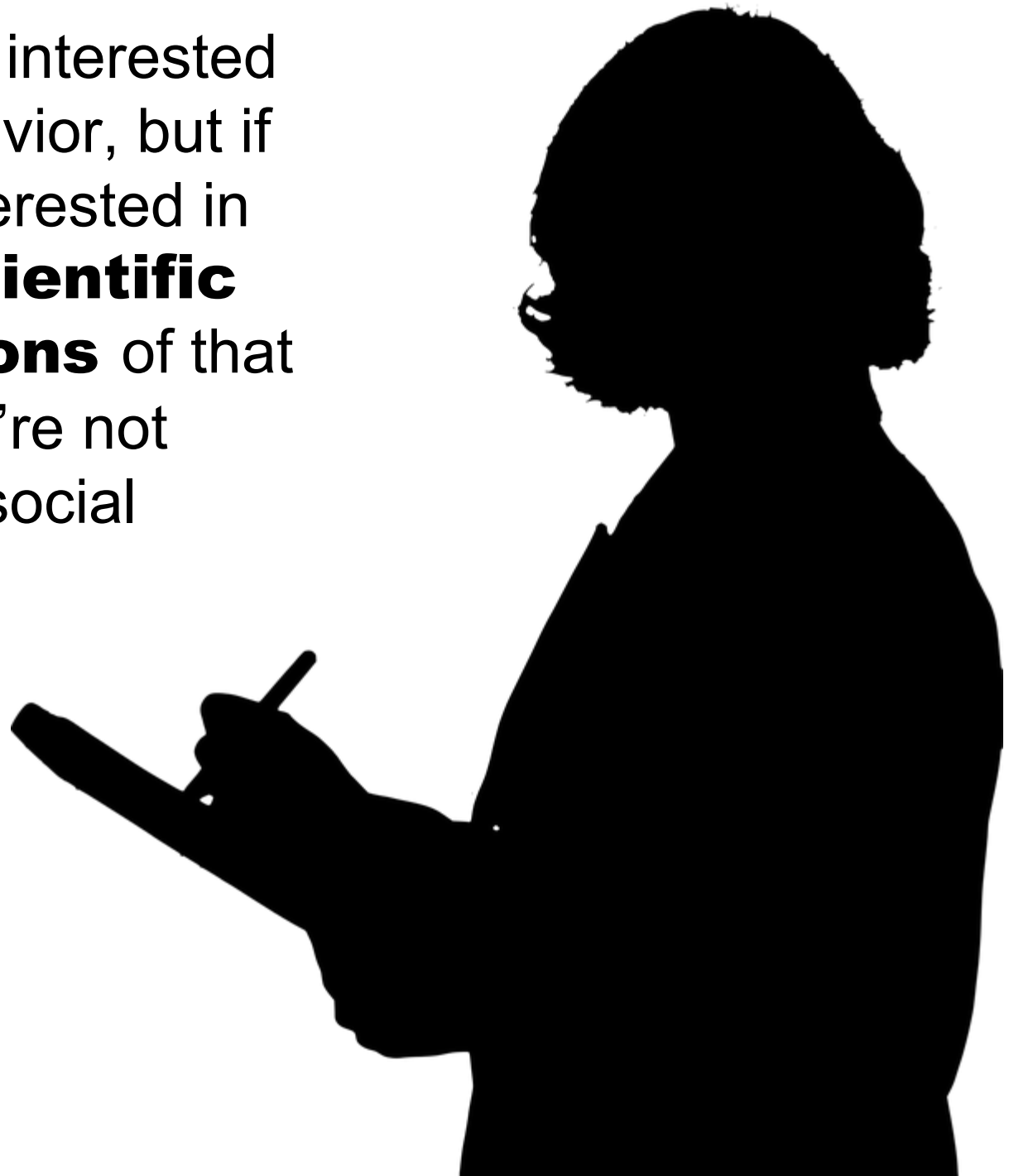
social psychology

is about

empirical

research

You might be interested
in social behavior, but if
you're not interested in
**rigorous scientific
investigations** of that
behavior, you're not
interested in social
psychology.

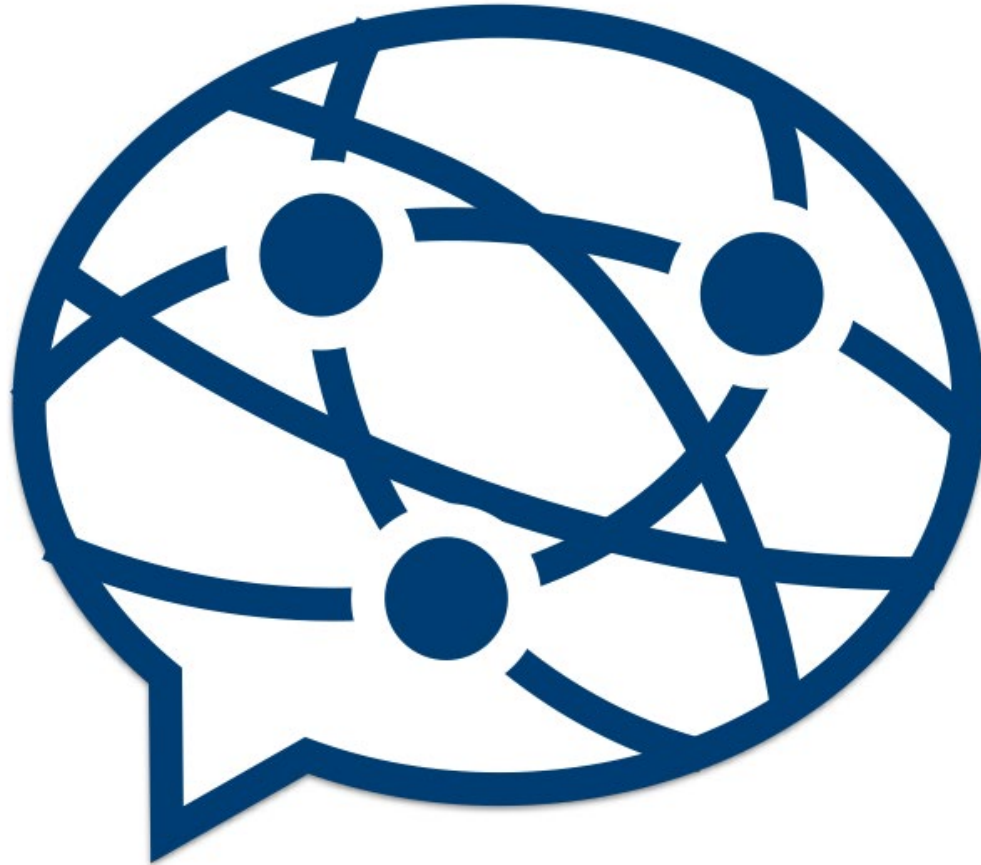


hindsight bias



“I knew that was going to happen.”

conceptual variables



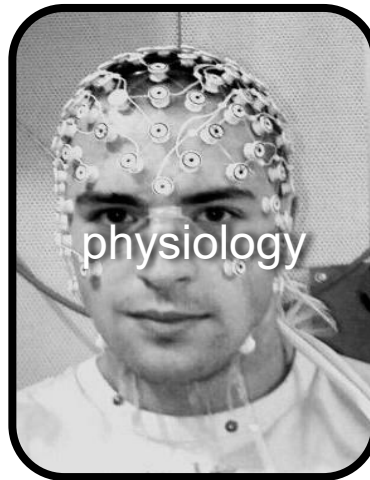
boredom

conceptual def. An affective state composed of lack of stimulation, low physiological arousal, and unpleasant feelings.



boredom

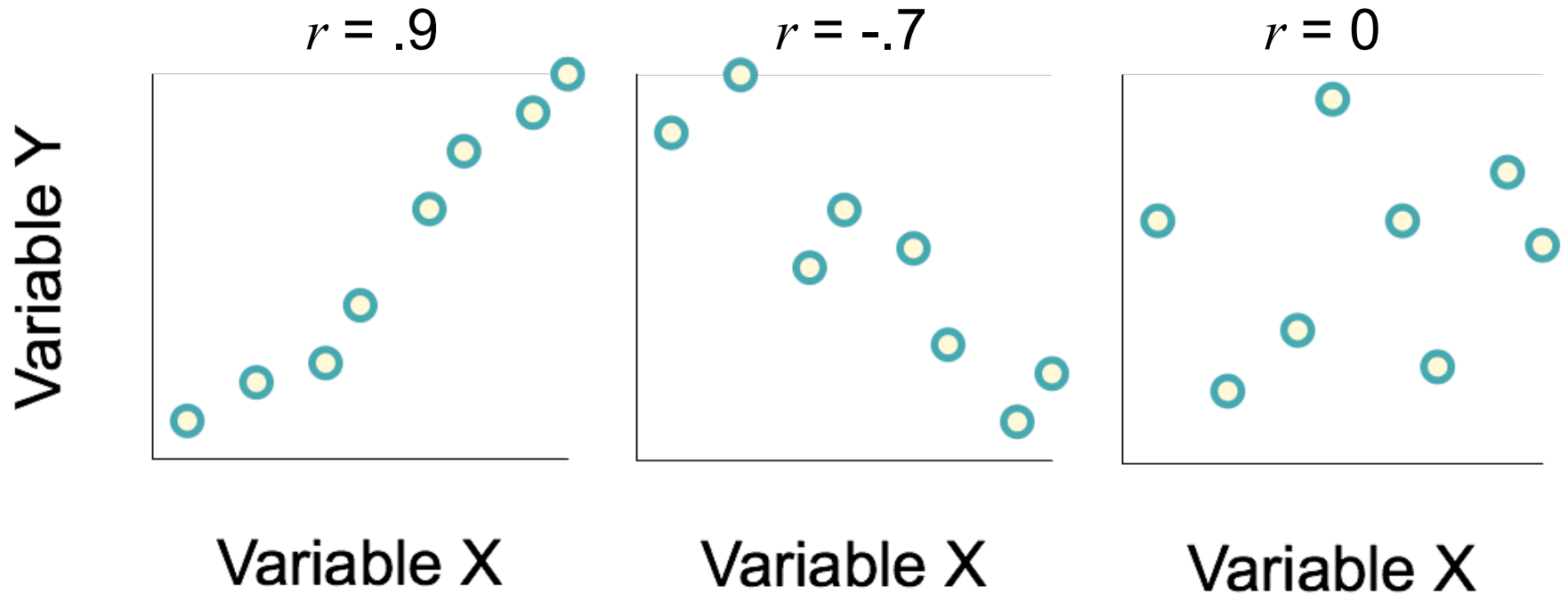
conceptual def. An affective state composed of lack of stimulation, low physiological arousal, and unpleasant feelings.



operational def. the particular method used to measure a variable of interest.

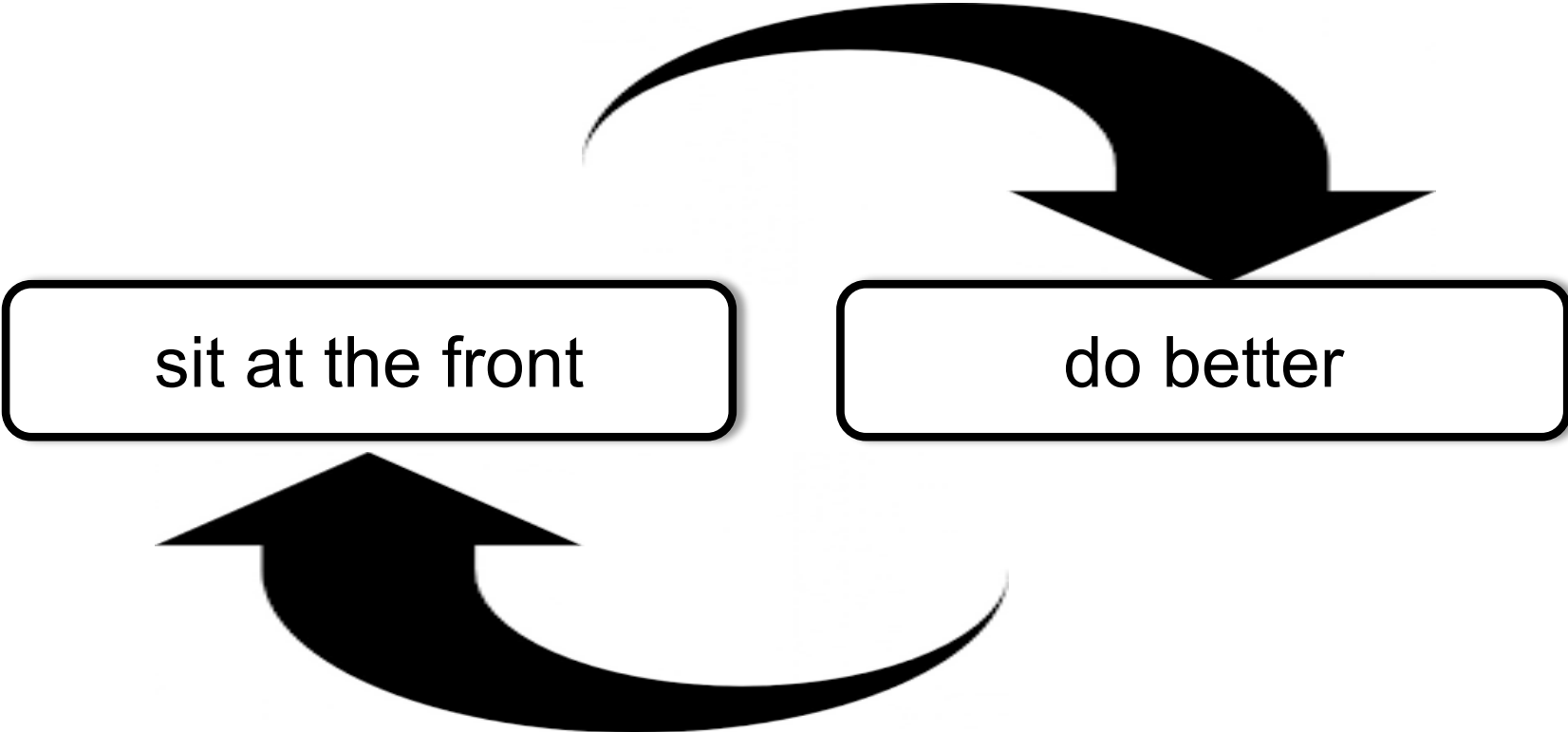
Research design	Advantages	Disadvantages
Observational: descriptive	Develop research questions	Cannot assess relationships
Correlation: Assesses relationships between variables	Assesses predictions, can assess real-world	Cannot assess cause-and-effect
Experimental: Manipulation of variables to assess cause-and-effect	Assesses cause and effect	Manipulating variables can be artificial, expensive, impossible

Simple **correlation** examines the relationship between two **measured** variables



A photograph of a classroom from the perspective of the back of the room. Rows of wooden chairs are arranged in the foreground and middle ground, facing towards the front. The chairs are made of light-colored wood and have some graffiti on them, including the word "LANE" and a star. At the front of the room, there is a large blackboard mounted on a white wall. To the left of the blackboard is a wooden podium with a laptop on it. Above the podium is a round clock. To the right of the blackboard are two speakers mounted on the wall. A doorway is visible on the far right. The text "People who sit at the front of the class do better in school" is overlaid in white on the middle of the image.

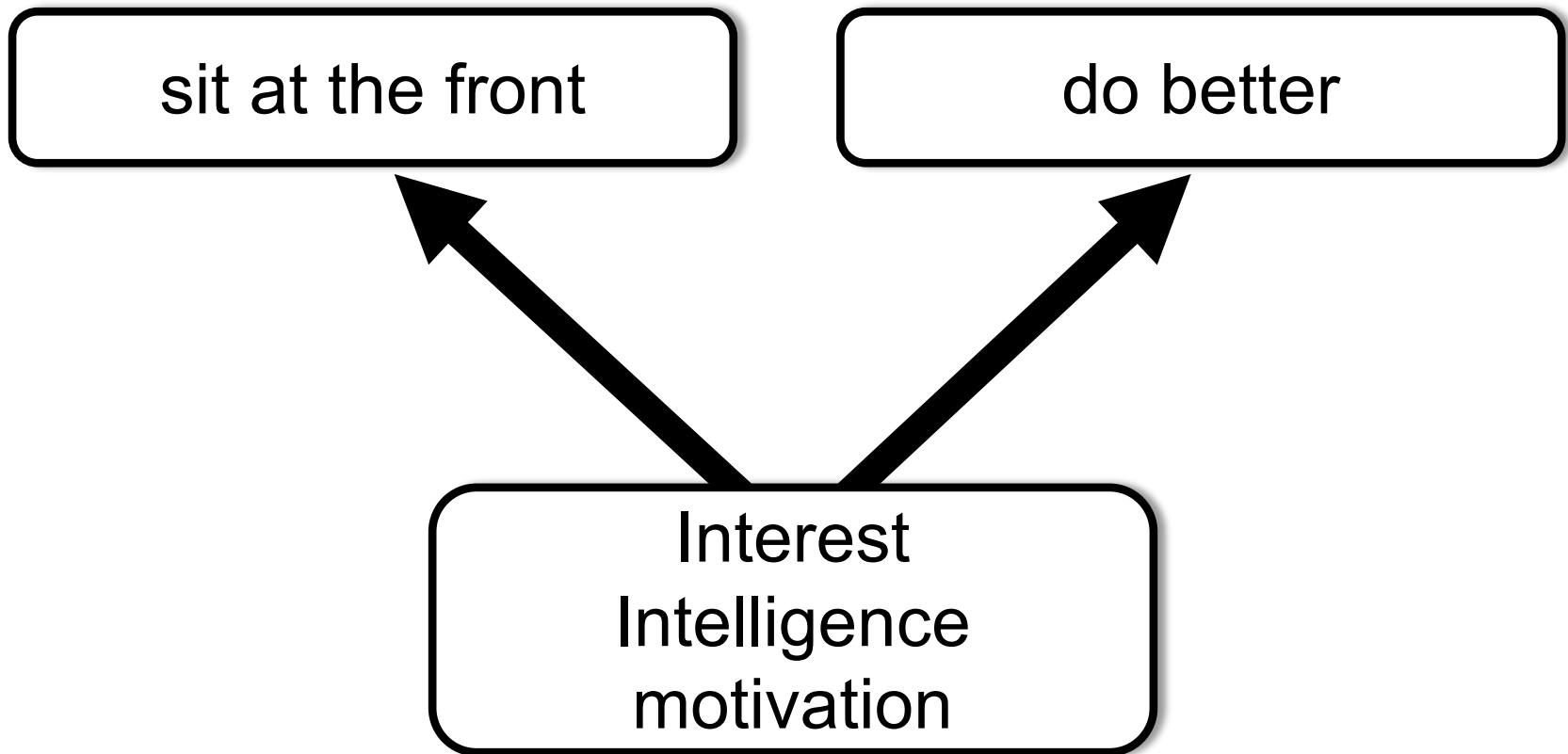
People who sit at the front of the class do better in school



sit at the front

do better

3rd **variables**



*Independent variable:
manipulated*

sit **front** half

cause

*Dependent variable:
measured*

course grade

difference?

sit **back** half

cause

course grade

Experiments assess whether differences in the **manipulated variable** (X) cause differences in the **measured variable** (Y).

internal validity

*Independent variable:
manipulated*

sit **front** half

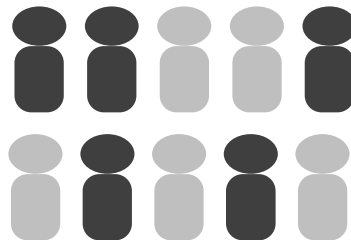
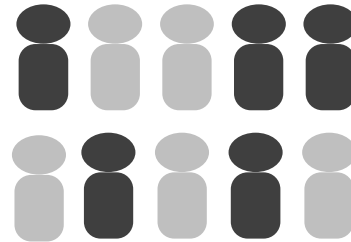
sit **back** half

The **only difference**
between the two conditions
should be the experimental
manipulation.

*Independent variable:
manipulated*

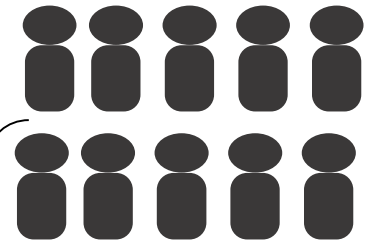
sit **front** half

sit **back** half

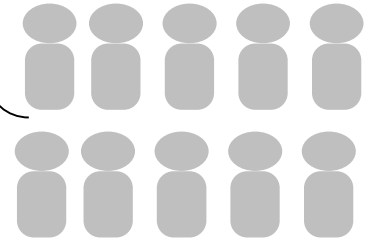


randomly
assign

motivated



unmotivated



deception

A black and white photograph of a person's back, wearing a vertically striped shirt. A hand is placed on the person's lower back, with fingers slightly curled. The image is used as a visual metaphor for deception.

When researchers tell participants a cover story about the research or use an **experimental confederate** in their study, they must thoroughly debrief participants.

external validity



The extent to which you can expect relationships identified in one **study**...



to hold in another study, with different people, or out in the “**real-world**”.